



AFTER

Sherman's March to the Sea had inflicted a devastating blow on Southern morale while making Sherman a hero in the North.

INTO THE CAROLINAS

Sherman did not burn Savannah like he did Atlanta and Columbia, South Carolina. Instead, he spent the winter there, putting his veterans on the road again a few weeks later—**this time headed north**. And rather than dispatching his men to Petersburg to reinforce Grant, he **plundered his way through the Carolinas** in the same way he had done through Georgia. General Joseph E. Johnston, brought back from retirement, would try to stop him with an **army of barely 30,000 men** (see [The Carolinas and Alabama](#)).

DESTROYING HOOD'S ARMY

Before Sherman departed Atlanta, he had quipped that if Hood would go "to the Ohio River, I'll give him rations ... **my business is down south**." Hood had tried doing just that, but he and his Army of Tennessee were virtually **destroyed by George Thomas at the Battle of [Nashville](#)**.